Muncie Policy Memo

Civic Meeting Report

Delaware County Drainage Board - October 14th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XlOoDOyjHeM
Publication Date	2026-10-15T02:18:50Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Report: Delaware County Drainage Board

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the October board meeting to order, welcoming attendees and leading the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Members Present:** Mr. Whitehead, Mr. Hamilton, Mr. Reagan, Mr. Christie, Mr. Buckel (Buckhalter), Mr. Brown, Mr. Burress.
  - **Members Absent:** None noted.
  - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly stated by name, though acting as chair.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by the presiding officer.
- **Approval of Minutes:**
  - **Item:** Approval of the September meeting minutes.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed 5-0 via roll call vote (`Mr. Whitehead`, `Mr. Hamilton`, `Mr. Reagan`, `Mr. Christie`, and `Mr. Buckel` voting yes).

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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:04:40 **Tabled Business: Selma Open Ditch**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Sawyer
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Sawyer reported that there are still moving parts and clarification needed with the landowner and the Town of Selma. County attorneys are scheduled to meet with the Town of Selma later in the week.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Kept tabled for the next meeting by consensus.
- 00:08:49 **New Business: Abe McConnell Watershed Separation**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Shalaya (Surveyor) / Mr. Hamilton
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion focused on separating out the 125 parcels of the Abe McConnell Watershed (a sub-watershed of No Name Creek) into a separately managed account for drainage assessments and repair billing. Concerns were raised by Mr. Sawyer regarding the low fund accumulation ($1,200<U+2013>$1,500/year) versus high repair costs (e.g., sinkholes, pipe repairs) and whether this would require constant fund-shuffling or premature rate increases. Proponents argued that individual accounts ensure fairness so other watersheds do not shoulder repair burdens, noting that O.W. Krohn, Banning Engineering, and Lochmueller can assist with financial and technical navigation.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** No formal vote taken; the Surveyor's office will continue working on the project with support from GIS and consultants.
- 00:31:59 **New Business: Wiley Excavating Log Jam Quote**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Surveyor (Tom)
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Wiley Excavating provided an $18,000 quote to remove three log jams on Jones Road. Because the amount exceeds the $10,000 threshold, the board discussed procurement rules.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Board recommended soliciting at least three quotes for work over $10,000.
- 00:33:38 **Old Business: De-Brushing Specifications and DNR Coordination**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Surveyor / Board Attorney
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The surveyor confirmed he contacted the DNR regarding de-brushing to the top of the opposite bank. The DNR stated their handbook is a strong recommendation, but Indiana code supersedes DNR guidelines regarding regulated drains. Specifications are ready, and an independent contractor

agreement is being drafted by the attorney (including a 20% performance/compliance clause and liability insurance requirements). Quotes will be advertised, with a due date of November 9 at 4:00 PM. Discussion also occurred regarding whether to mandate fescue seeding behind de-brushing; the surveyor noted it adds rural expense and that selective herbicides (like Garlon 3A) preserve grass banks.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Specifications approved to go out for quotes; due November 9.
- 00:43:20 **Old Business: Recording of Hog Creek and A.B. McConnell**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Surveyor
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Kathy at Ashton's is preparing a legal description for the Hog Creek tributary (open ditch at 700) to be recorded with the recorder's office to finalize its status as a regulated drain. She is also researching 2009 records for the A.B. McConnell watershed.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; ongoing research by staff.
- 00:45:34 **Old Business: Regulated Drain Mapping & GIS Accuracy**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Hamilton / Mr. Surveyor / Kevin (GIS)
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Following an inquiry by Jesse Landis regarding washouts on a tile thought to be a regulated drain, it was discovered that the drainage board dashboard/Beacon maps contained mapping errors, showing drains where none exist (or vice versa) due to historical overlay discrepancies. Kevin, a new GIS staff member formerly with Beacon and Wabash County, noted it is straightforward to update Beacon and read legal descriptions.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Kept on the agenda for next month; GIS staff to coordinate with the Surveyor to systematically correct map discrepancies.
- 00:52:59 **Old Business: River Valley and 900 West Tile Issues**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Surveyor
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding tile blow-holes and sinkholes along River Valley Road and 900 West (Rodney Reed property). Exploratory digging will begin now that crops have been harvested.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; staff to proceed with digging once crops are off.
- 00:54:50 **Old Business: Investment of Maintenance Funds**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Surveyor
    - **Deliberation Summary:** The drainage maintenance fund holds $1,025,044.84. With upcoming de-brushing and tile projects, the board reviewed moving $900,000 into an investment account, leaving approximately $125,000 for working cash and

claims. Interest earned may be routed to the general drain improvement fund for greater spending flexibility.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and seconded to move $900,000 into the investment account; approved by the board.
- 00:59:11 **Approval of Maintenance Claims**
    - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Member / Surveyor
    - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of maintenance claims submitted for the period.
    - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
    - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and seconded to approve maintenance claims as submitted. Passed via roll call vote (`Mr. Servais`, `Mr. Ardoin`, `Mr. Cassio`, and `Mr. Buckhalter` voting yes).

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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 00:05:35 **Ron Markham**
    - **Affiliation:** Delaware County resident (Selma)
    - **Key Concerns:** Introduced his local contracting business specializing in trenching, ditching, gravel driveway restoration, mowing, brush clearing, and forestry mulching. Offered services to the county and was advised by the board to submit liability insurance, a W-9, an equipment list, and hourly rates to the surveyor.

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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
    - **Next Meeting Date:** Due to a scheduling conflict on Wednesday, the next meeting is rescheduled for **Tuesday, November 10**.
    - **FEMA Funding Update:** Board inquired about Corey Cassio's work with FEMA regarding log jam removal funding; Mr. Servais reported no definite response yet and agreed to follow up.
    - **County Mower Partnership:** Commissioners Stephen Brand discussed the county's new Morbark heavy-duty mower ($230,000 value with multi-season cab and attachments), noting that while roads are the priority, future coordination on ditch maintenance is worth discussing (though tire constraints on soft ground must be considered).
- **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn carried by voice vote.

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